

100 Days of Azure DevOps

# Day 14 Handout — PR templates, work items & review etiquette

Learning in public · Personal lab only · Educational content · Not a sales pitch

## Architecture A — pull request anatomy

| PR Element     | What it captures            | Good practice                                      |
|----------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Title          | One-line change summary     | Avoid 'fix' / 'update' — say what changed          |
| Description    | What / Why / How verified   | Use a template so fields are never blank           |
| Work item link | Boards ↔ Repos traceability | Link User Story or Task (AB#123)                   |
| Files review   | Diff of every changed file  | Self-review before assigning reviewers             |
| Reviewers      | Human gate before merge     | Ask for risk & clarity feedback, not rubber stamps |

## Architecture B — review etiquette that scales

| Role     | Do this                              | Avoid this                                 |
|----------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Author   | Fill template; self-review Files tab | Empty description; surprise reviewers      |
| Reviewer | Ask about edge cases and risk        | Personal comments; nitpick without context |
| Team     | Approve when merge-ready             | Approve out of politeness                  |
| Process  | Link work items; keep PRs small      | Mega-PRs that take a day to read           |

## One-liner to remember

A PR is a contract between the author and the team · If the contract is empty, do not expect a safe merge

## Step-by-step lab (20–30 min)

In your local clone of **azure-100-labs**:

- 1 Create branch: **git switch -c feature/day14-pr-template**
- 2 Create folder: **.azuredevops/**
- 3 Add **pull\_request\_template.md** with What / Why / Test plan / Risk
- 4 Commit: **git commit -m 'chore: add pull request template'**
- 5 Push: **git push -u origin feature/day14-pr-template**
- 6 Open PR in Azure Repos: feature → main; fill template; link a work item
- 7 Self-review the Files tab before inviting reviewers

## PR template skeleton

```
## What
-
## Why
-
## Test plan
- [ ] Local build / sanity check
- [ ] Linked work item
- [ ] No secrets in the diff
## Risk
- Low / Med / High
```

## Done checklist

- PR template committed under .azuredevops/
- PR opened with filled description
- Work item linked from Boards
- Self-review completed on Files tab

## Tomorrow — Day 15

Advanced Git — rebase, squash, and history hygiene for clean CI/CD.